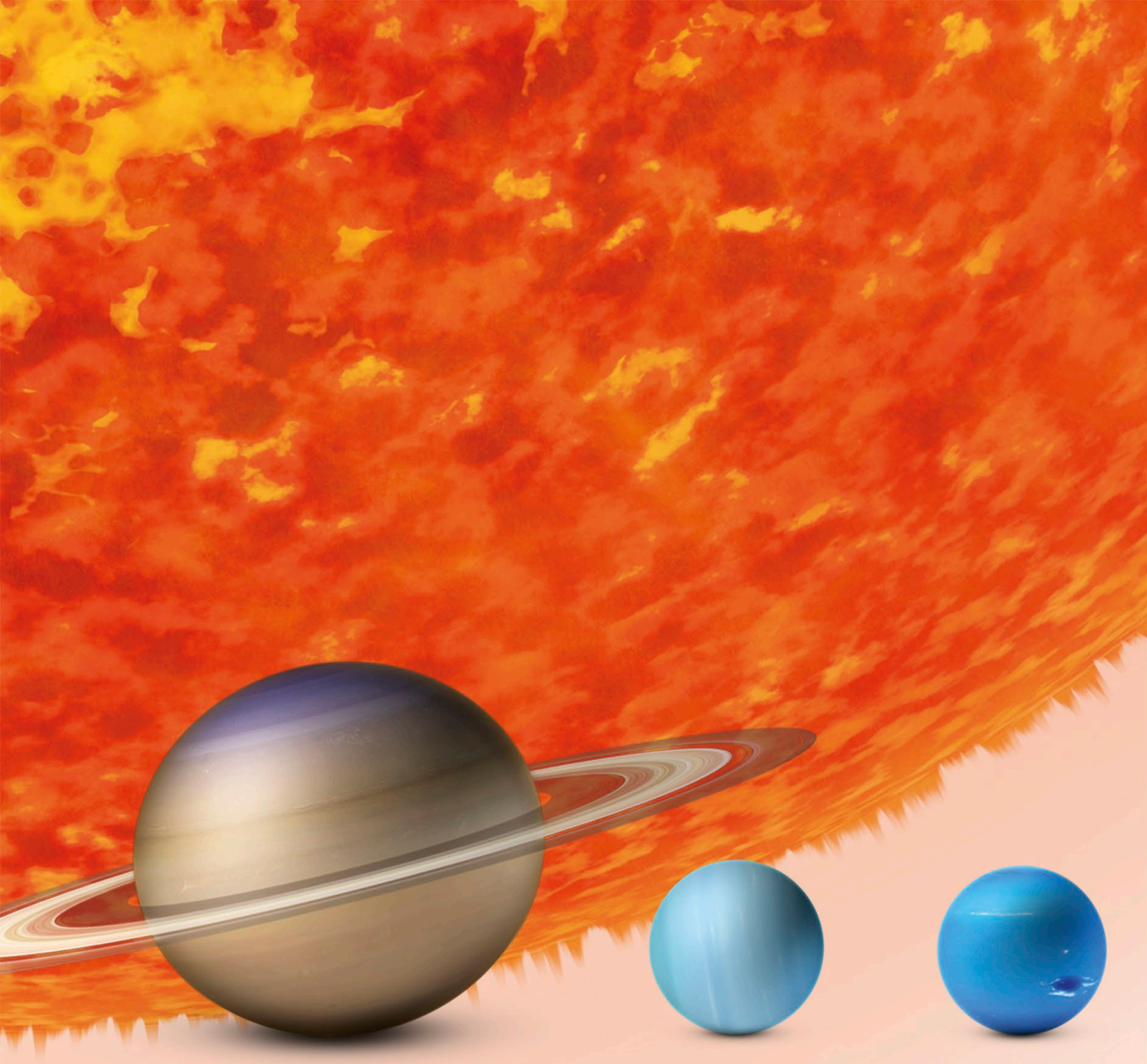




The small patch of the Universe we understand best is the “Solar System” – the Sun and its family of planets. These worlds include our planet Earth, the third rock from the Sun, and the gas giants beyond. Earth is the only planet in the Universe known to support life.